

STARTER PUNJAB

Paneer tikka (dahi-ajwain, no garlic)

Signature starter from Punjab, cooked without onion or garlic.

YIELD 4 portions	PORTION 1 portion	SERVICE Hot	TIME Prep 25 min - Cook 20 min
---------------------	----------------------	----------------	-----------------------------------

Vegetarian | No onion | No garlic | No eggs | No meat | No fish | Gluten Free*

Cookware: Cast-iron grill or steel oven tray - never aluminium foil

INGREDIENTS - 4 PORTIONS

QTY	UNIT	APPROX	INGREDIENT
400	g		paneer cubes
1	cup	~ 240 g	hung dahi
1	tsp	~ 2.5 g	ajwain
1	tsp	~ 6 g	Kashmiri chilli, turmeric, garam masala, salt, ginger
1	pieces	~ 100 g	capsicum plus 1 tomato, cubed

METHOD

- Mise en place. Weigh 400 g paneer and 1 cup hung dahi. Set a cast-iron grill or steel oven tray - never aluminium foil. Confirm chilli powder and garam masala have no onion or garlic powder.
- Cut paneer into even 2.5 cm cubes. Pat very dry. Cut capsicum and tomato into similar squares so they cook in the same time.
- In a steel bowl whisk hung dahi with 1 tsp ajwain, 1 tsp Kashmiri chilli, turmeric, garam masala, salt and crushed ginger to a thick marinade that coats a spoon. No garlic paste.
- Fold paneer and vegetables through the marinade until every face is coated. Cover. Marinate 1 hour refrigerated (or 20 minutes at the pass if you are short of time).
- Thread onto steel skewers, alternating paneer and vegetable, leaving a little space between cubes so heat can circulate.
- Heat the cast-iron grill to medium-high until a drop of water dances. Brush with ghee. Lay skewers. Do not crowd.
- Grill 3-4 minutes per side until the dahi takes charred spots and the paneer is hot through. Turn with tongs. Brush once more with ghee.
- Doneness: edges blistered, centre hot, dahi set not wet. Rest 1 minute so juices settle.
- Finish with lemon juice at the pass. Serve 1 skewer per portion, hot. Hold no more than 10 minutes or the tikka steams and goes rubbery.

NUTRITION PER PORTION

KCAL 311	PROTEIN 20 g	CARBS 6 g	FAT 23 g	FIBRE 1 g
-------------	-----------------	--------------	-------------	--------------

Nutrition is a kitchen estimate from typical produce values, not a laboratory analysis.

ALLERGENS

- Milk
- Always verify labels; this card is a kitchen estimate, not a lab certificate.

CHEF NOTES

For Paneer tikka (dahi-ajwain, no garlic): keep the mix slightly drier than you think; wet mixes split or go greasy. Bloom hing in hot

fat 20-30 seconds; raw hing tastes medicinal. Commercial hing is often cut with wheat flour - use a gluten-free hing if you must mark Gluten Free. Never cook tomato, tamarind, lemon, yogurt or milk in aluminium; use stainless steel, iron, clay or glass. Spice blends: read the packet. Many garam masalas hide onion or garlic powder. Pat paneer dry and do not boil it hard or it turns rubbery. Bring yogurt to a simmer gently and stir; a rolling boil can split it.

SERVICE NOTES

Serve immediately while crisp or hot. Offer a chutney or raita that is also onion-garlic free. Service temperature: Hot. Allergen label for this dish: Milk; Always verify labels; this card is a kitchen estimate, not a lab certificate. State clearly: vegetarian, no onion, no garlic, no eggs, no meat, no fish. Nutrition on this card is an estimate for 1 portion of 4.